

From The Labs

Rebuilding the internet for the future ▶ 44

Robot mega-tanks

DARPA (Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency) wants to build AI-enabled super tanks!

Smart Buildings

The Japanese have started building houses that are completely managed by robots

Anyway, I'm getting pushed around in this crowd, because I'm trying to get to the café, and not to the protest. Finally, just as I manage to free myself, I see iRobot's security systems kick in - all the protesters within 20 feet of the entrance got zapped by tasers. Serves the buggers right.

And to think, I was so close to being zapped myself!

Posted by RobotFan at 5.11 PM 17 Comments

AUGUST 12, 2047

Wakamura performance: awesome!

After watching Wakamura in action, I'm wondering if it's his talent I'm impressed with, or that he's come so far.

Wakamura started out with a small part in a 20-minute Japanese play called Hataraku Watashi (I, Worker), back in 2008. Even then, his every circuit oozed talent. Of course, back then his part was practically pre-programmed, but his performance received rave reviews, and his abilities have only become better since then. In 2013, he got his first lead role - a small adaptation of Asimov's The Caves of Steel. By 2022, he was getting nominated for awards, and in 2024, he won his first Emmy.

Thankfully, nobody's made any more robot actors - that would just dilute Wakamura's appeal. Not to mention that we don't need robots replacing us in the cinema as well.

Posted by RobotFan at 11.19 AM 16 Comments

AUGUST 11, 2047

Wakamura performance today

In about two hours, I'll be in the audience at the Ballmer Memorial Theatre, watching Mitsubishi's [award-winning Wakamura](#) perform in the Lord of the Rings. I've been a big fan of Wakamura for the past ten years, so you can imagine (or can't, actually) how exciting this is.

I must now go iron my tuxedo. Stay tuned for the performance report, and I suppose I owe you a history lesson, too.

Posted by RobotFan at 4.54 PM 4 Comments
July 1, 2047
I bought a dog!

...a [BigDog](#), to be precise. I've been saving up for this day for almost four years now. Well, not exactly. I've had the money all this while, but the military has only just decided to let [Boston Dynamics](#) manufacture BigDogs for RobotFans like lil ol' me.

Here's a picture:

He's a little less than three feet tall, weighs about 75 kilos, can go wherever I go, and can keep his balance even if I kick him in the side! But the best part is that he can carry close to 140 kilos in those cool military bags (included in the price), which means that I can start camping without worrying about backpacks now!

He's also fully electric - not like the military's hybrid versions, so he isn't as powerful or dangerous (thankfully) as the military 'Dogs.

I haven't decided what to name him. Suggestions?

Update: I'm a big fan of retro characters, and clearly so are you - meet Gromit!

Posted by RobotFan at 3.44 PM 22 Comments

MAY 3, 2047

First self-repair sighting!

It's an exciting day! Like many of you, I've been itching to see the new [ckBot 4.0](#) in action - but it's hard to see a self-repairing robot in action when it rarely breaks itself, lol.

